

COMP 3550

**VISION STATEMENTS:
LANGUAGE & STRUCTURE**

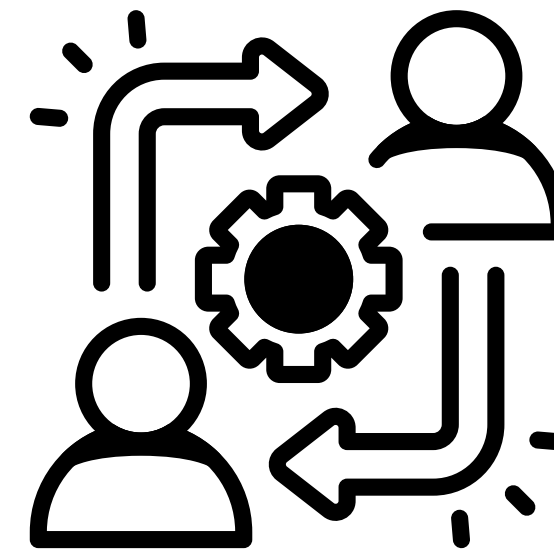
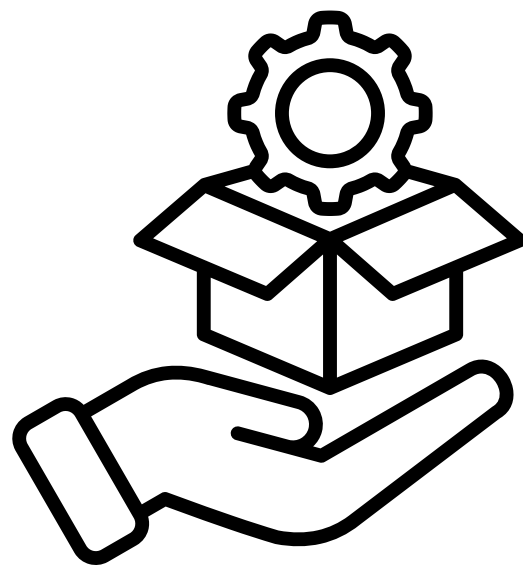
Supplementary Video Set



WHAT A VISION STATEMENT ACTUALLY **IS**

Answer 3 core questions:

1. Who is the product for?
2. What problem are we solving?
3. What change will exist because our product exist?



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In the real world: we want to talk about what sets us apart.

In this course: we recognize we aren't revolutionizing a domain but we can still talk about what makes our product awesome

WHAT A VISION STATEMENT IS **NOT**

Our system leverages a multi-layered architecture with working data storage to deliver a robust and scalable solution to problem X...



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There is:

- No person.
- No problem.
- No tension.
- No reason this should exist.

It's just... architecture vocabulary.

WHAT A VISION STATEMENT IS **NOT**

This application provides users with functionality to manage tasks efficiently through our easy-to-use interface.



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- What users?
- What tasks?
- Why do they need help?
- What is going wrong right now that we are trying to fix?

WHAT A VISION STATEMENT **IS**

We help overwhelmed university students keep track of assignment deadlines across all their courses so they stop missing submissions.

- What users? **University students**
- What tasks? **Tracking deadline**
- Why do they need help? **They are overwhelmed**
- What is going wrong right now that we are trying to fix? **They keep missing submission deadlines!**



KEY DISTINCTIONS:

CS Report	Human
The system will...	Students can...
The architecture supports...	Newcomers feel...
The application enables efficient data processing...	Small businesses stop worrying about...



WHY THIS MATTERS

We aren't used to this part of development. Assignments are given with all the specifics laid out. The vision chosen for you.

Now Vision drives decision making. Just like when I am deciding what content or questions to cut, I consider the course vision and learning objectives. You consider your vision when you decide:

- features need to be cut
- edge cases considered
- what is worth your time



WHY THIS MATTERS

When planning out a new project from an idea, you want to ask yourself:

Does this move us closer to our vision?

If your vision is vague, technical, or bloated, it cannot guide decisions.

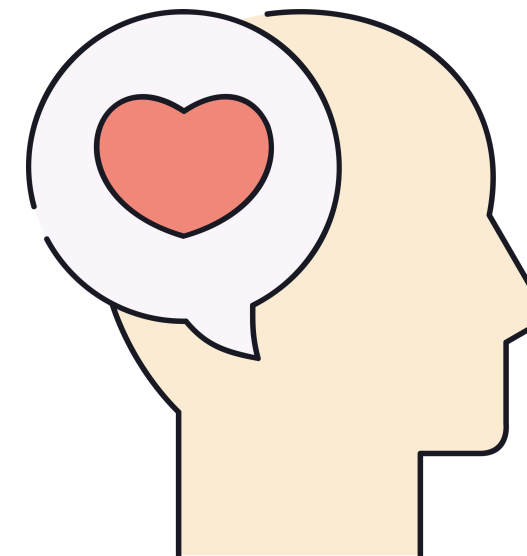
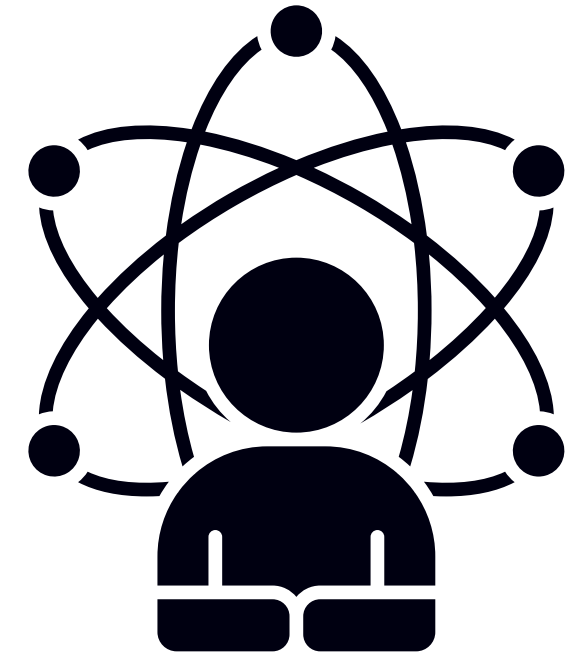
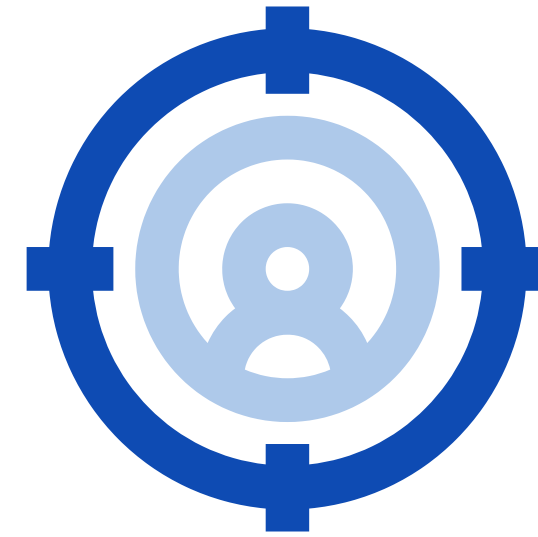
A good vision helps you say no.



BUILDING A STRONG VISION STATEMENT:

Four Components:

1. Target User
2. Core Problem
3. Desired Outcome
4. Emotional/Practical Impact

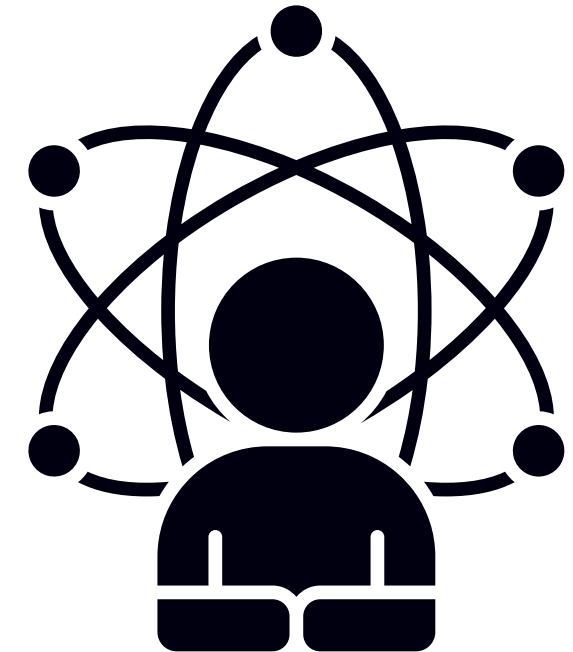
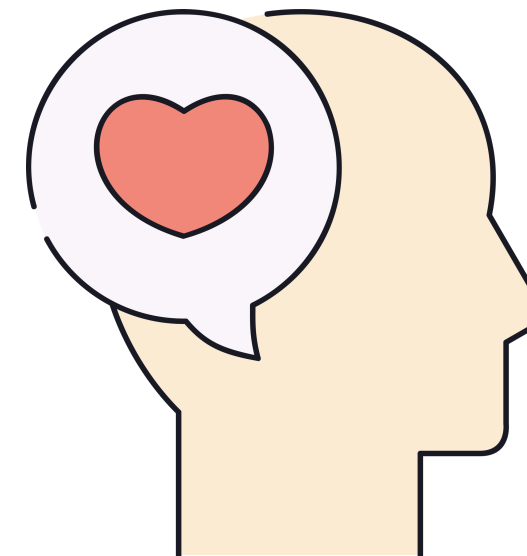
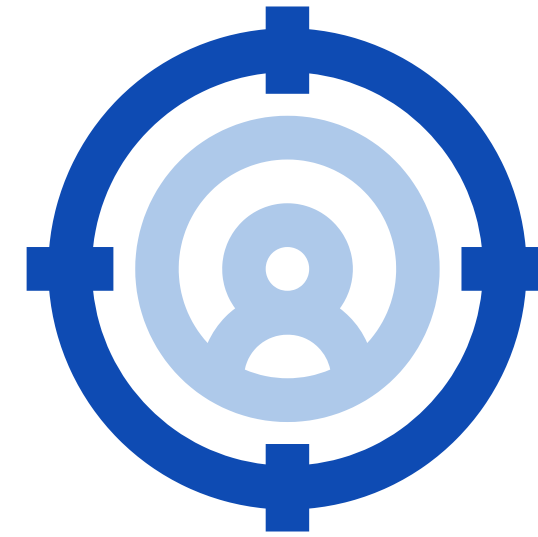


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“For [target user], we provide [core solution] so they can [achieve outcome] without [current frustration].”



WEAK VS STRONG EXAMPLE

Weak: *“Our system is a task management application that allows users to create, edit, and delete tasks with persistent storage.”*

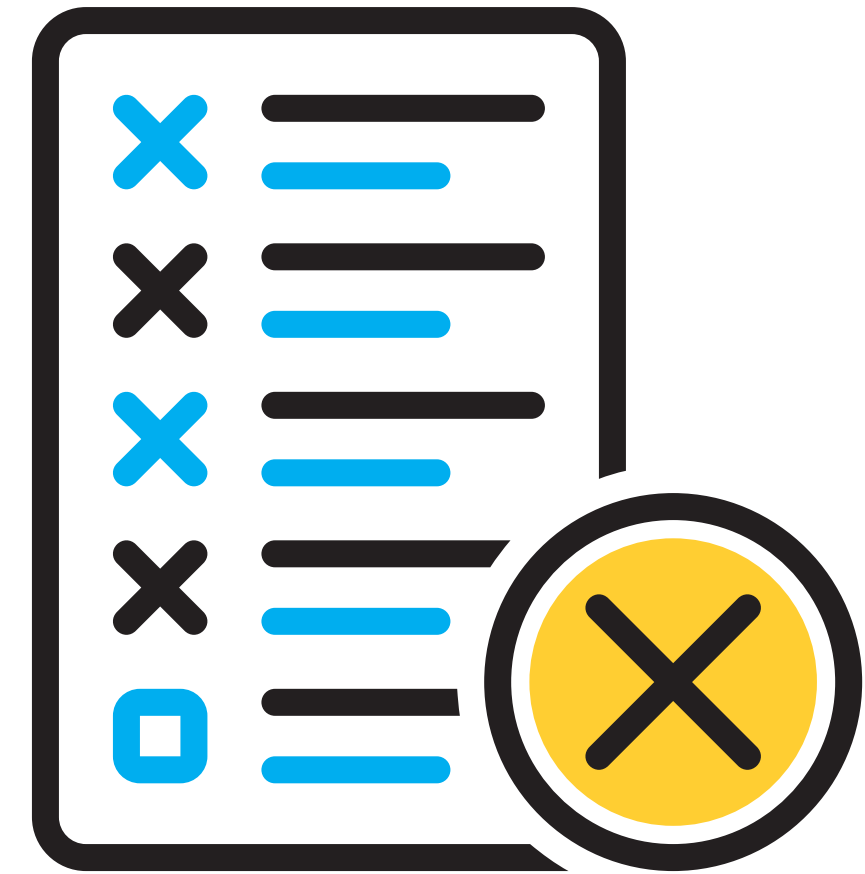
Strong: *“We help overwhelmed university students stay on top of deadlines so they feel in control instead of constantly behind.”*

1. Does this feature reduce overwhelm?
2. Does this make deadlines clearer?
3. Does this help students feel in control?

COMMON MISTAKES/PATTERNS

Here are the patterns I want you to avoid:

1. Listing features instead of stating purpose
2. Writing in third-person academic tone
3. Overusing technical vocabulary
4. Being so generic that it applies to everything
5. Trying to sound “professional” instead of clear



Clarity > sophistication.

FINAL TAKEAWAY

- A vision statement is not documentation or an explanation of how your software works.
- It's a compass and should be:
 - clear
 - human
 - focussed
 - directional

